



STANDING TALL
(clockwise)
Preeti Bajaj, EVP- Home Solutions, Schneider Electric; smart home concept; Unica Pure+ switches

The Indian home is undergoing a silent, digital revolution. The modern household is becoming an AI-native ecosystem. To understand how artificial intelligence is moving from our smartphone screens into our electrical panels, we sat down with Preeti Bajaj, Executive Vice President (EVP) of the Home Solutions Division at Schneider Electric. As a seasoned global executive, formerly the CEO of Luminous Power Technologies, Bajaj is now leading Schneider's global mission to make homes smarter and more sustainable. In our wide-ranging conversation, we explored her vision for the intersection of safety, sustainability and the futuristic concept of energy in your hand.

From Chatbots to Circuit Breakers

The conversation began with a fundamental shift: if we use AI to write emails and plan our days, why shouldn't our homes do the same for our resources? Bajaj pointed out that as homeowners become accustomed to tools, they naturally expect their living spaces to be equally intuitive. "AI-native in the operating software means it is actually managing the energy and electrical infrastructure," explains Bajaj. It's about knowing exactly what your Geyser, AC or EV charging is costing you in rupees at any given moment.

Private Sanctuary

Addressing scepticism regarding privacy and the fear of being hacked, Bajaj clarified that Schneider Electric utilises Edge Computing to keep sensitive information within the four walls of the house. "We are working on technologies that are mostly edge-controlled at the compute level in your home. We don't take the data away," she explains. Furthermore, she sees AI as a great leveller. Through micro-segmentation, Schneider ensures that whether you live in a 1,000 sq ft apartment or a 10,000 sq ft farmhouse, you can adopt the parts of the AI ecosystem that fit your budget.

Aggregating the Ecosystem

Bajaj uses a relatable analogy for the modern consumer: the ease of a food delivery app. "You simply see an app, a bit like your Zomato delivery," she notes. Just as you track your dessert, you can track your production versus consumption. The goal is orchestration, not displacement. Schneider aims to be the intelligence leader that manages all devices in one place, regardless of the brand. "We are not trying to actually displace anyone... We simply make Wiser connect to the rest of the home so homeowners can manage energy intelligently," Bajaj says, comparing the model to how aggregators work with restaurants.

Identifying the Energy Guzzlers

For most, the electricity bill is a mystery. Bajaj identified three main culprits—the Geyser, the AC, and the EV Charger—which typically account for 60 per ecnt of a home's bill. By highlighting these guzzlers in real-time, systems like Wiser (from Schneider) remove the cognitive load from the homeowner. You don't have to guess why your bill went up; the AI tells you.

The Math of Resilience

The numbers are staggering. A standard 5kW solar system can produce roughly 18,000 units per year. At an average cost of ₹8 per unit, that equates to ₹1,44,000 in annual savings. In a climate-challenged world, this isn't just about saving money; it's about reducing the 22 per cent of global carbon emissions contributed by residential spaces.

A Smarter, Greener Horizon

Bajaj's vision for the future of Indian living is one where energy is no longer a hidden cost or a source of anxiety, but a visible, manageable and sustainable asset. By marrying 190 years of electrical safety heritage with cutting-edge AI orchestration, Schneider Electric is turning the smart home from a futuristic concept into a practical reality for the middle-income household.

Whether it is through the launch of new Experience Centres in Noida or the Home Zones in their Bangalore office, the goal remains the same: putting the power of a micro-grid into the palm of every Indian homeowner's hand. As Bajaj puts it, the AI must work for you, making life simpler, safer and significantly cheaper.